

Hidden Cost Tracker

See what your debts, installments, buy-now-pay-later plans and subscriptions really cost you, and catch the ones quietly costing the most.

REAL APR

worked out

from just your monthly payment

FREE TRIALS

cancel-by

date and countdown for each trial

EVERY MONTH

% committed

of your income, before you spend

WHAT IT CATCHES · FROM THE EXAMPLE ROWS

Phone installment plan	24 × \$67 on a \$1,200 phone	29.8% APR	HIGH
Sofa store financing	24 × \$105 on a \$2,000 sofa	23.3% APR	HIGH
Laptop pay-in-4	4 × \$200 on an \$800 laptop	0.0% APR	OK
Sports streaming	7-day free trial, then \$9.99 a month	cancel in 2 days	TRIAL
Gym + beauty box + 2 more	ticked "Cancel it?"	save \$1,104 / yr	

STEP 1 · GET YOUR OWN COPY

OPEN MY TRACKER →docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1mf8O2rSzNAd6WaSIgbVTferaLwHAwF7cTmPzG6vwcu0/copy

Click the button, then choose **Make a copy**. The copy is yours, saved in your own Google Drive. Nobody else can see what you enter, including us.

Ready in about five minutes

1

Make your copy

Open the link on page 1 while signed in to Google and press **Make a copy**. No Google account? Create a free one first.

2

Add your numbers

Start with **Settings** (your monthly take-home pay), then add your debts and subscriptions. The example rows are made up: overwrite or delete them.

3

Check the Dashboard

See your highest real APR, what's due next, which free trials to cancel and what you'd save each year.

Colour code

Columns with a **BLUE header** are yours to fill in. Columns with an **ORANGE header** calculate themselves: leave them alone.

Tick **Cancel it?** on any subscription you plan to drop. The Dashboard shows the yearly saving straight away.

On your phone

Install the free Google Sheets app, open the copy from your Drive and update it anywhere. Phone in dark mode and the colours look washed out? Tap  > **View in light theme** to see the design as intended.

Prefer Excel?

In your Google copy choose File > Download > Microsoft Excel (.xlsx). Everything calculates. Tick boxes turn into Yes/No cells: just type Yes or No.

Please don't "Request edit access"

The link opens a view-only master. Always use **Make a copy** so you have a file you can edit.

Five tabs, one clear picture

Dashboard	Income vs money already committed each month, highest real APR, interest still to pay, next charges, free trials to cancel, yearly savings. Switch the spending chart between <i>By category</i> and <i>By subscription</i> .
Debts & Installments	Credit cards, loans, store financing, BNPL. Real APR, payments left, debt-free date, and the order to pay them off (avalanche and snowball).
Subscriptions	Price, billing cycle, next charge date, days until it hits, free-trial cancel-by date and countdown. Filter by category, billing or status.
Settings	Your income, the APR levels that trigger a flag, how many days' warning you want, and the drop-down lists.
How to Use	These instructions, inside the sheet.

"Real APR": the number shops don't show

Store financing and installment plans often show only a monthly price. Enter what you borrowed, the monthly payment and the number of payments, and the tracker works out the yearly interest rate hidden inside. Example: \$1,200 paid as $24 \times \$67$ is about **29.8% APR**.

What the flags mean

HIGH real APR at or above 20% (you can change this in Settings). Pay extra on these first.

CHECK at or above 10%. Worth a look.

OK lower-cost debt. Keep paying on time.

FAQ

Is my information private?

Yes. Your copy lives in your own Google Drive. We never see it, and nothing is sent anywhere.

Can I add more rows?

There is room for 20 debts and 30 subscriptions. To add more, insert a row inside the table (not below it), then copy the row above and paste it into the new row so the formulas come with it.

My currency isn't dollars.

Select the money columns and choose Format > Number > Currency (or Custom currency) to switch the symbol. The maths stays the same.

I overwrote a formula by mistake.

Use Undo, or open the link on page 1 again and make a fresh copy. Google Sheets also shows a warning before you edit a calculated cell.

Need help?

Message us through Etsy and we'll reply as soon as we can.

Estimates only, not financial, legal or tax advice. Real APR is estimated from your payment schedule and does not include fees charged separately; your contract is the final word. For personal use only: please don't share or resell the template link.